

Student Life & Living Abroad

Discussion and Debate - Week 2
LSE Pre-sessional

Session Content

- Discuss student life and the challenges/opportunities of living abroad and learn to:
 - express opinions clearly and confidently
 - give reasons and examples to support your views
 - Agree and disagree politely
 - negotiate with others to reach a shared decision
 - contribute actively to group discussions

Ranking Challenge

- Let's begin with a pair discussion.
- Rank these from most important to least important for succeeding on a Master's degree.

Ranking Challenge

- Intelligence
- Hard work
- Curiosity
- Organisation
- Self-confidence
- Communication skills
- Creativity
- Good lecturers
- Friends
- Luck

Ranking Feedback!

- Compare your rankings with the group next to you.
- What were your rankings, and why did you make those choices?

Discussion Challenge

- With your group, you will now have a series of questions to discuss.
- For each discussion, you will receive a number of challenges. See how many you can complete.
- You will now be given cards with details of your task. Keep your task secret! Read your cards for a moment.
- Once your ten minute discussion time is up, collect your mission cards. Shuffle them, swap them with the neighbouring group, and redistribute for the next discussion.

Discussion 1

What will university be like in 20 years?

Discussion 2

You have a week with no work, no study, and an unlimited budget.

How would you spend that week?

Main Task: Student Spending Committee

- LSE has just been awarded £1m to improve student life.
- Your committee has to decide how to spend it!
- Unfortunately, despite the size of the grant, there isn't enough to fund every proposal.
- Download the **University Funding Scenario** and spend a few moments reading.

Committee Rules

- **Rule 1 — Everyone must speak**
 - Before the committee reaches a final decision, every member must have contributed at least once.
- **Rule 2 — No immediate voting**
 - Don't vote straight away. Discuss each proposal before deciding.
- **Rule 3 — Every decision needs a reason**
 - You can't simply reject a proposal. You must explain why.
- **Rule 4 — Spend the whole budget**
 - You're not allowed to finish with unused money.
- **Rule 5 — One change only**
 - Once the committee agrees to fund a project, it can only be removed if the whole group agrees.
- **Rule 6 — Think about everyone**
 - Your final proposal should benefit as many different students as possible—not just yourselves.

NEWSFLASH

- The LSE Senate have just confirmed that the funding has to be reduced to **£750,000!**
- Your group has to now re-evaluate your spending priorities!

Presentation - Town Hall

- Each group has 2-3 minutes.
- Explain:
 - key priorities;
 - one difficult decision;
 - one thing that changed after the budget cut.

Reflection

- Spend a few moments reflecting on today's lesson.
- What did you learn about applying different discussion practices today?
- What can you take from today's lesson and apply immediately to your daily conversations / social interactions?
- Is there a particular discussion/conversation skill you'd like to practice and improve?